British Government relating to federation, but it was even more applicable to the proposals brought by Sir Stafford Cripps. The more one thought of these proposals the more fantastic they grew. India became a chequer-board containing scores of nominally independent or semi-independent states, many of them relying on Britain for military protection of autocratic rule. There was to be neither political nor economic unity and Britain might well continue to exercise dominating power, both politically and economically, through the many petty states she controlled.* What the British War Cabinet had in mind for the future I do not know. I think Sir Stafford Cripps meant well for India and hoped to see her free and united. But this was not a matter of

** The entire dependence of the Indian States on British power and protection is stressed by Sir Geoffrey de Montmorency in his ' The Indian States and Indian Federation1 (1942):*

The states 'are still so numerous in India that they offer a grave conundrum in evolution to which no solution is at present forthcoming.. .. Their disappearance and absorption would, of course, be inevitable if Britain ever ceased to be the supreme power as regards India.'

individual views or opinions or personal goodwill. We had to consider a state document, carefully drafted in spite of its deli-